

mechanism sensitive to train wheels was fitted on the rails such that when the wheels ran over it, the “starter” would be alerted and shift to danger. Other tokens used included the “Carsen” instrument, the Theobald key token, the Dutton-Neville Block instrument, and the Webb and Thompson electric token staff.

Additional improvements

Interlocking came up in the railways in India after an accident on the Eastern Bengal Railway in 1868. The Lonavala–Poona section of the GIPR started using it followed by the Madras Railway and Indian Midland Railway, which implemented the system in some stations. In 1892 GH List and A Morse installed interlocking apparatus at some stations on the North Western Railway. Together, they brought out the famous List and Morse system on the railways in India. In 1894, the stations between Lahore (in modern-day Pakistan) and Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh started using the List and Morse interlocking system. By 1910, many stations had interlocking systems in place. Initially, key interlocking was operated by the manual transfer of keys, which were eventually replaced by much faster electric key transmitters.

With the growth of traffic, there was a need for an improved signalling system. Although “cabin interlocking” existed as early as 1893, it took flight only in the 20th century. In 1912, the GIPR became the first railway to incorporate this on the entire stretch between Delhi and Bombay with other railway companies following suit in the subsequent years.